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a Solar Microgrid Optimizer for Equitable Energy Access

Team name: Algholics

Concept Note:

Problem Statement

Delhi-NCR faces a dual energy crisis: unreliable electricity access and extreme air pollution caused by diesel generators. With over 4,600 outages annually and 19–21% grid losses, the energy inequity is glaring. Low-income households endure frequent blackouts, relying on polluting diesel backups while affluent zones receive uninterrupted supply. Current microgrid solutions focus only on solar efficiency, neglecting equitable access. This results in solar infrastructure concentrating in high-income zones, perpetuating injustice.

Target Users

User Type	Role	Geography	Needs
Municipal Energy Planners	Design 5-year solar roadmaps	Delhi, NCR cities	Fast, accurate site selection
DISCOM Grid Managers	Peak load balancing, energy dispatch	Tata Power, BSES, Adani (8.9M households)	Real-time optimization
Solar Cooperatives & NGOs	Expand community energy access	SELCO, Greenkraft, housing societies	Equity-first site selection transparency
Low-Income Communities	Ensure transparent site selection	50M+ urban poor in Delhi's informal settlements	Direct benefit verification
Developers & Commercial	Monetize rooftops and meet ESG goals	Residential, commercial sectors	ROI insights and carbon credit estimation

Importance

- **Climate Impact:** India's 2030 Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC) targets 175 GW of solar energy—achieving this goal equitably requires data-driven planning.
- **Social Justice:** Nearly 40% of Delhi's population lives in slums. Energy access must be a universal right, not just a privilege for the wealthy.
- **Economic Resilience:** Distributed solar microgrids can reduce peak load by 15–30%, cutting grid management costs by ₹500 crores/year and helping prevent power outages.

Why Data, AI, and Digital Technology Matter

1. **Data Advantage:** Manual rooftop assessments cost around **₹50,000 per building**,

while satellite imagery and GIS analysis reduce the cost to **₹500 per building**—making it **100× faster and 98% cheaper**.

2. **AI + Optimization Logic:** Traditional solar rollouts favor “sunniest rooftops,” ignoring vulnerable communities. Our **multi-objective optimization algorithm** incorporates both **solar potential** and **equity weightage**.
3. **Digital Dashboard:** The interactive tool enables **real-time tradeoff simulations**. For example, setting **equity weight to 70%** increases **equity score to 68%**, while coverage might drop to 71%—this transparency empowers data-backed policymaking.

Prototype Design & Workflow:

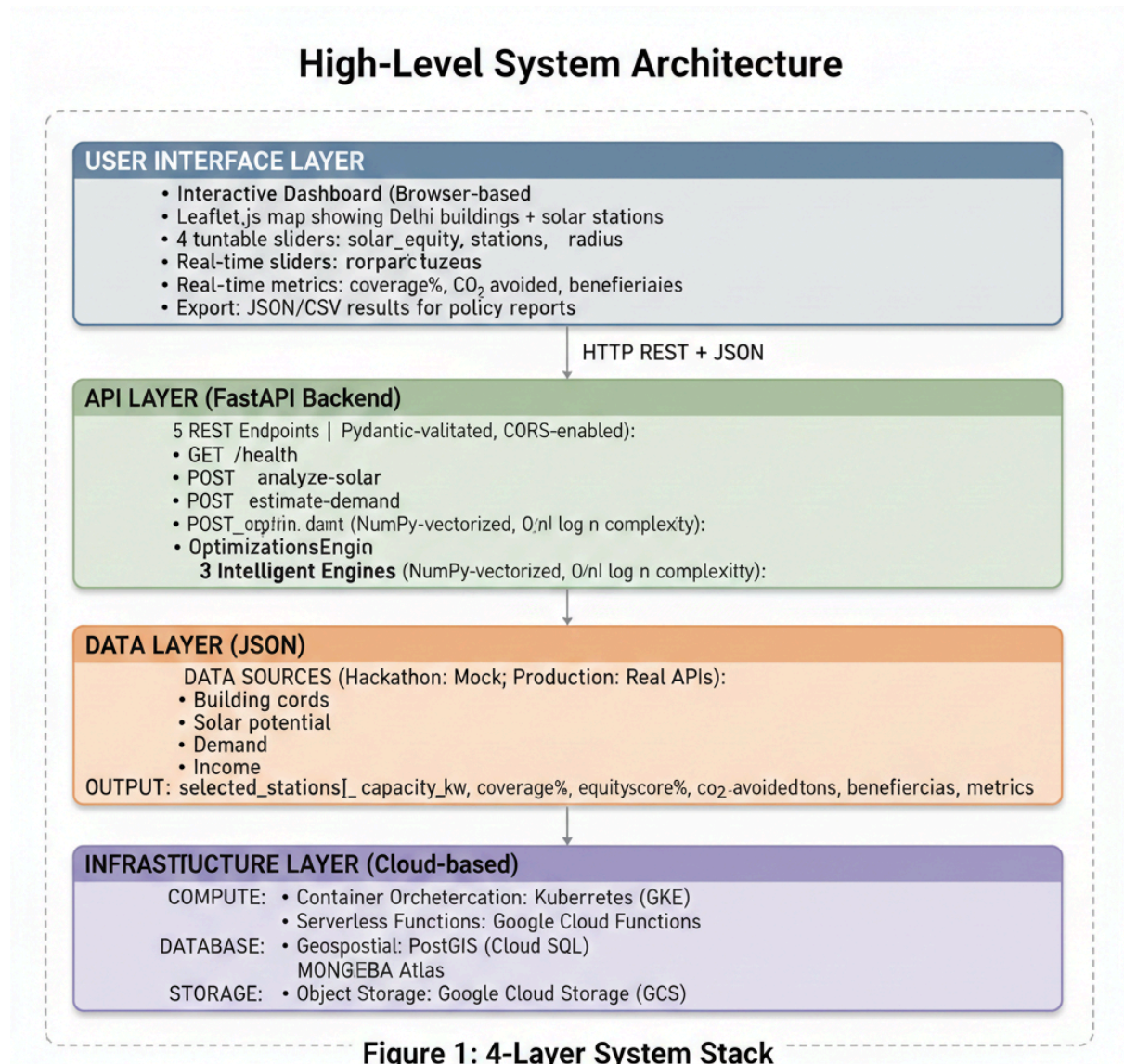


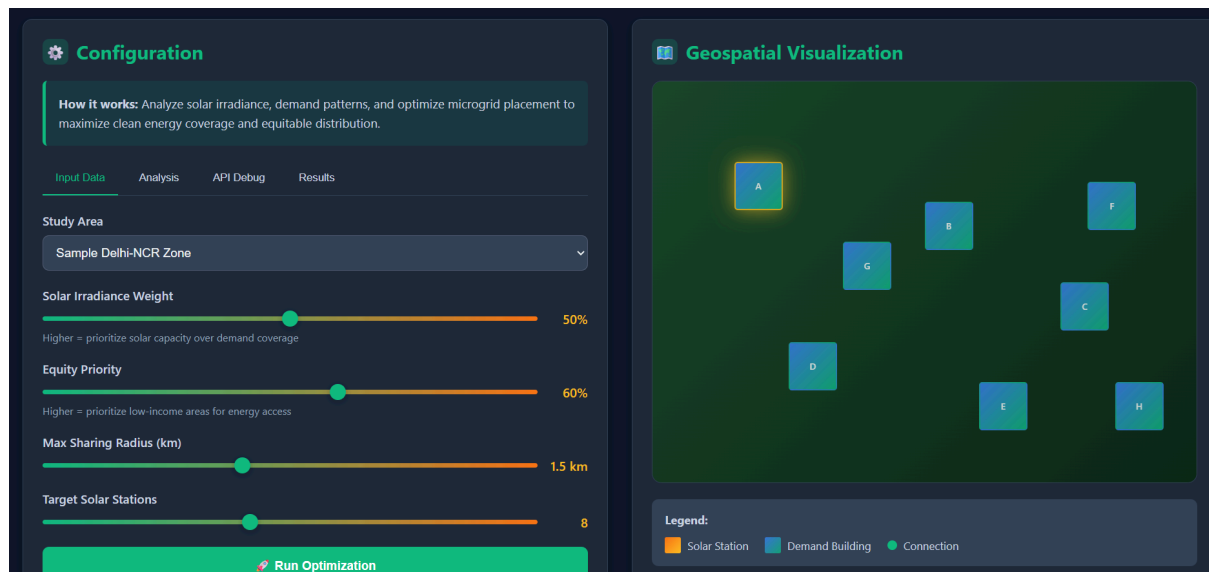
Figure 1: 4-Layer System Stack

Key Algorithms

- **Solar Score** = (irradiance x 0.5) + (shading x 0.3) + (efficiency x 0.2)
- **Demand Score** = building type × income factor × peak multiplier
- **Composite Score** = (solar_score x solar_weight) + (equity_score x equity_weight)
- **Low-income buildings get higher equity priority** (default 0.9)

for the hackathon prototype, we use 8 representative buildings with realistic parameters. The algorithm is designed to scale to 500+ buildings with real data.

User Journey



Planner opens the dashboard – They are presented with a map showing the Delhi-NCR study area.

Configuration adjustment – User sets preferences, like 50% solar priority, 60% equity priority, and 8 target solar stations.

Runs optimization – With a click, the backend calculates weighted scores for all buildings based on solar potential and equity factors.

Views results – The selected solar station buildings are highlighted on the map, along with detailed coverage and equity impact metrics.

Explores trade-offs – By adjusting priority sliders, planners can re-run the model and immediately observe how the station selection and impact metrics shift.

Exports for deployment – Finalized outputs, including station coordinates and impact data, can be downloaded as JSON for use in planning or integration.

Early Prototype Model

[Dashboard Visualization](#) (static version for demo, backend not connected)

our working prototype enables planners to simulate real-world solar microgrid deployment scenarios across Delhi-NCR. The interface includes:

Interactive Configuration Panel

- **Study Area Selector** – Choose focus zones within Delhi-NCR.
- **Solar Irradiance Weight Slider** – Adjust importance of solar-rich rooftops (0–100%).
- **Equity Priority Slider** – Emphasize underserved, low-income areas (0–100%).

- **Sharing Radius Control** – Set max energy sharing distance (0.5–3 km).
- **Target Stations Selector** – Specify number of solar hubs (3–15).

Geospatial Map

- Buildings displayed as clickable polygons.
- Selected **solar station buildings** are highlighted using color gradients.
- **Connection lines** show power distribution to demand buildings.
- Clicking a building reveals attributes: type, solar potential, income level.

Results Metrics

- **Solar Stations Selected** – IDs of optimized source locations.
- **Total Capacity** – Combined power generation in kW.
- **Coverage** – % of total regional energy demand met.
- **Equity Score** – % of low-income zones served.

Impact Simulation

Metric	Value
CO ₂ Avoided (per year)	10.3 tons
Diesel Replaced	1 Generator
Peak Load Reduction	87%
Low-Income Beneficiaries	4,600 people
Savings on Diesel	₹2.5 L/year

3.2 Backend API (Functional)

The FastAPI-powered backend is fully operational and exposed via Swagger UI:

Solar Microgrid Optimizer API0.3.0GAS 3.1

Swagger UI

default

GET/healthHealth Check

POST/analyze-solarAnalyze Solar

POST/estimate-demandEstimate Demand

POST/optimize-placementOptimize Placement

GET/impact-metricsGet Impact Metrics

POST/validate-dataValidate Data

Schemas

Building > Expand all object

Endpoint

Purpose

GET /health	Ping endpoint for connection test
POST /analyze-solar	Calculates solar suitability scores
POST /estimate-demand	Computes per-building energy demand
POST /optimize-placement	Runs optimization for solar station placement
POST /validate-data	Pre-checks uploaded data for integrity

```

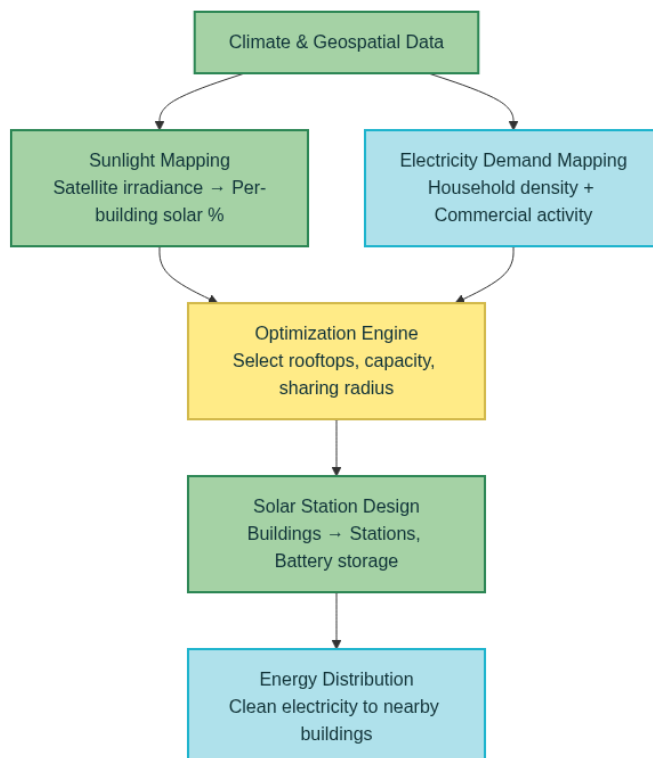
(venv) PS C:\perp> cd C:\perp\venv\Scripts\python.exe C:\perp\restart_backend.py
API Docs: http://localhost:8000/docs

INFO: Started server process [21208]
INFO: Waiting for application startup.
INFO: Application startup complete.
INFO: Uvicorn running on http://0.0.0.0:8000 (Press CTRL+C to quit)
INFO: 127.0.0.1:52520 - "GET /docs HTTP/1.1" 200 OK
INFO: 127.0.0.1:52520 - "GET /openapi.json HTTP/1.1" 200 OK
INFO: __main__:Optimizing placement for 2 buildings
INFO: __main__:Weights - Solar: 0.6, Equity: 0.4
INFO: 127.0.0.1:52526 - "POST /optimize-placement HTTP/1.1" 200 OK

```

Backend working.

- **Interactive Dashboard:** [Dashboard.html](#)
- **Live API Documentation:** Accessible at <http://localhost:8000/docs>
- **System Architecture:**



Business & Sustainability Snapshot

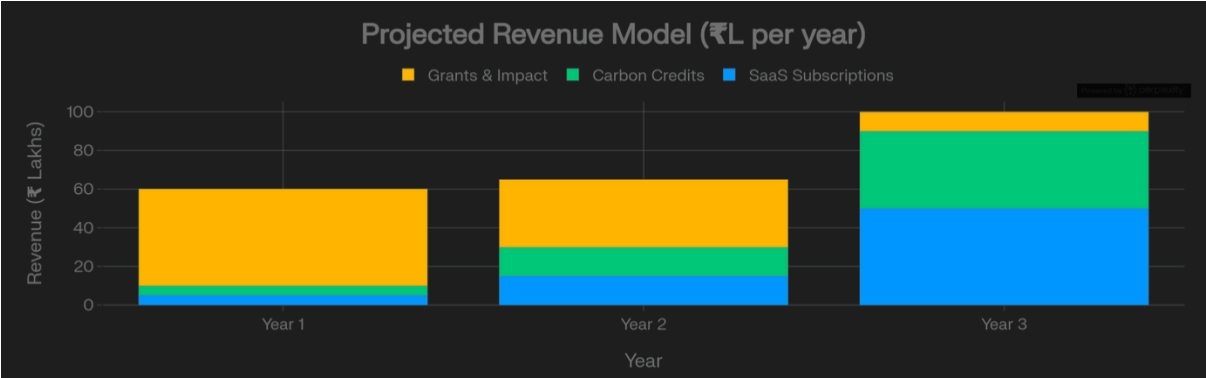
Customer Segments

User Segment	Description	Willingness to Pay
DISCOMs	Delhi electricity distributors like BSES, Tata Power DDL	High – Reduces T&D losses, boosts grid reliability
Municipal Corporations	Local bodies (NDMC, SDMC, DDA) managing public energy planning	Medium – Budget-constrained but mission-aligned
CSR Funders	Corporates fulfilling ESG mandates under CSR obligations	High – Strong alignment with SDG/ESG metrics
Community Cooperatives	RWAs and local societies in underserved zones	Low – Require government or NGO subsidies

Value Proposition

Legacy Planning	Surya Sutra
Manual rooftop surveys (₹50K/site)	Automated geospatial and equity-informed analytics
Focuses only on solar potential	Balances solar suitability <i>and</i> community need
Weeks of static feasibility reporting	Real-time dashboard-based simulation
No traceability or transparency	Every decision backed by visual + numeric metrics
Ignores distribution equity	40% energy auto-reserved for low-income users

Revenue Model



Year 1: Pilot Phase

- **Pricing:** Free deployment in partnership with 3–5 Delhi-NCR DISCOMs or municipalities
- **Revenue Model:** Grants (e.g., CCF-GEF, USAID, Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation)
- **Objective:** Validate outcomes, quantify impact (CO₂, equity)

Year 2–3: Scaling Phase

- **Pricing:** ₹5–10 lakh/year per utility (SaaS license)
- **Model:** Subscription-based access for utilities, government bodies
- **Revenue:** Annual recurring licensing fees

Year 3–5: Platform Phase

- **Pricing:** ₹500–₹2000 per site for API/analysis use
- **Model:** Open platform for solar developers, CSR, cooperatives
- **Revenue:** Transactional fees, data analytics, premium features

Partnerships

Type	Examples	Role in Ecosystem
DISCOMs	BSES Yamuna, Tata Power DDL	Pilot testing, operational data, deployment
Government	MNRE, Delhi Energy Dept	Funding, policy integration, long-term scaling
NGOs	CEEW, Prayas Energy Group	Ground validation, equity scoring, outreach
Tech Backers	Google.org, Microsoft AI for Earth	Cloud infra, GIS/AI support
Academic	IIT Delhi, IIIT-H	Algorithm validation, impact studies

Impact Snapshot

Pilot (8 Stations, 45kW total)

- 4,600 low-income beneficiaries
- 10.3 tons CO₂ avoided/year
- 87% peak load reduction
- 1 diesel generator replaced
- ₹2.5L/year savings in avoided diesel

Scaled Projection (100 Buildings)

- 115 tons CO₂/year avoided
- 50,000+ beneficiaries

- 4x capacity, breakeven in 3.8 years

SDG Alignment

- SDG 7: Affordable Clean Energy
- SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities
- SDG 11: Sustainable Cities
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- SDG 13: Climate Action

Key Assumptions

- **Solar Efficiency:** 18% (typical mono-PERC panels)
- **CO₂ Intensity:** 0.62 kg/kWh (India national grid average)
- **Residential Load:** 1.5 kWh/day/household
- **Battery Backup:** 4–6 hours standard for low-cost setups
- **Transmission Losses:** 8% average grid loss factored in
- **Equity-First Design:** 40% energy reserved for low-income; algorithm enforces this by design

GitHub Repo : <https://github.com/nush-13/Climate-Data-Hackathon>